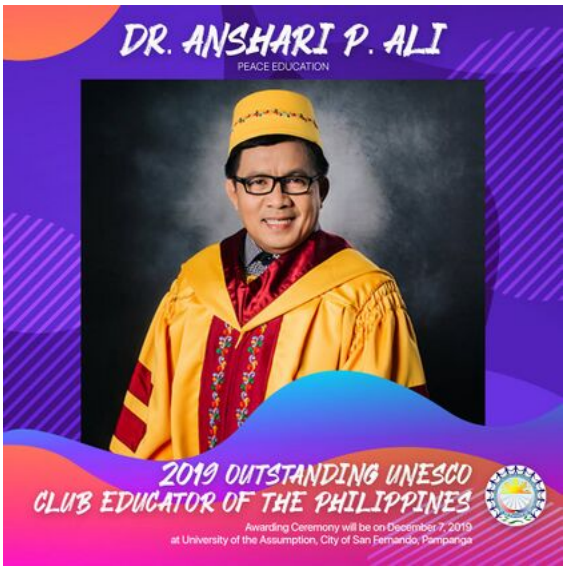
Anshari P. Ali

Dr. Anshari P. Ali was a distinguished Filipino Islamic scholar, Shari'ah lawyer, and academic administrator who served as the 6th Chancellor of Mindanao State University - General Santos (MSU-GSC) from 2018 to 2021. A visionary leader committed to transforming MSU-GSC into a globally competitive institution and national peace university, Dr. Ali's tenure was marked by groundbreaking initiatives including the establishment of Region XII's first College of Medicine, expanded international partnerships across Asia and the Middle East, and the modernization of university systems during the COVID-19 pandemic. As a Maguindanaoan scholar deeply rooted in Islamic jurisprudence and education, he dedicated his career to advancing quality education and improving the living conditions of Moro and Indigenous Peoples in Mindanao.

Dr. Anshari P. Ali



6th Chancellor of MSU-General Santos	
In office	2018–2021
Academic Background	
Alma mater	International Islamic University Malaysia (ISTAC)
Degree	Doctor of Philosophy in Islamic Civilization
Professional Identity	
Occupation	Academic Administrator, Shari'ah Lawyer, Professor
Known for	Educational Leadership, Islamic Scholarship, University Modernization
Recognition	
Awards	UNESCO Most Outstanding Educator (2019), Mindanao Governance and Leadership Excellence Award

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Background and Education

Dr. Anshari P. Ali pursued his doctoral studies at the International Islamic University Malaysia's International Institute of Islamic Thought and Civilization (ISTAC), where he earned his Doctor of Philosophy in Islamic Civilization. This advanced training in Islamic thought and civilization provided the intellectual foundation for his later work as both a legal practitioner and educational administrator. Beyond his academic credentials, Dr. Ali was a practicing Shari'ah lawyer and a certified member of the Shari'ah Bar in the Philippines, positioning him uniquely at the intersection of Islamic scholarship, legal practice, and higher education administration.

Academic Career

Dr. Ali began his academic journey at MSU-General Santos in 1992 as a faculty member, eventually rising to the rank of Full Professor VI. For nearly three decades, he taught Shari'ah courses in the College of Law Extension and Islamic Studies courses in the College of Social Sciences and Humanities' Islamic Studies Department. His classroom expertise spanned Islamic jurisprudence, family law, and the philosophical foundations of Islamic education. Before his election as Chancellor, he served as the Assistant Dean of the College of Law Extension, where he gained administrative experience that would prove valuable in his later leadership role.

Chancellorship (2018–2021)

Vision and Administrative Framework

Upon assuming the chancellorship in 2018, Dr. Ali articulated a dual vision for MSU-GSC: to become a globally competitive university while simultaneously fulfilling its mission as a national peace university. This framework guided his strategic initiatives throughout his three-year tenure, balancing academic excellence with social responsibility to the Bangsamoro region and Mindanao's Indigenous communities.

International Partnerships

During his first year in office, Dr. Ali aggressively pursued international collaborations, signing Memoranda of Understanding with universities and institutions across Asia that shared MSU-GSC's commitment to Islamic values and regional peace. Strategic partnerships were established with institutions in Brunei, Singapore, Indonesia, and the United Arab Emirates. To institutionalize and expand these global engagements, he created the Office of International Affairs, providing the university with dedicated capacity for managing international partnerships and student exchanges.

Dr. Ali also strengthened MSU-GSC's relationship with the Office of the Presidential Adviser on the Peace Process, working through the Campus Institute of Peace and Development in Mindanao to advance the university's role in peacebuilding efforts across the region.

Modernization and Innovation

Recognizing the imperative of technological advancement, Dr. Ali championed the creation of the Information and Communications Technology Office to modernize instructional modalities and administrative processes throughout the university. This initiative proved particularly critical as the institution navigated the challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic and the transition to remote learning environments. His vision of MSU-GSC as a "SMART University" reflected his understanding that technological integration was essential to remaining competitive in 21st-century higher education.

College of Medicine Establishment

One of Dr. Ali's most significant achievements was serving as the driving force behind the establishment of MSU-GSC's College of Medicine—the first medical college in Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN). This milestone represented a transformative moment in the university's history, expanding MSU-GSC's academic portfolio into medical education and addressing critical healthcare workforce needs in Mindanao. The college's creation demonstrated Dr. Ali's ability to translate institutional vision into concrete structural achievements.

COVID-19 Response

Under Dr. Ali's leadership, MSU-Gensan distinguished itself through its exemplary response to the COVID-19 pandemic. The university received a Special Citation from the General Santos City Local Government Unit for displaying exceptional practices and making significant contributions to the battle against COVID-19 in the Philippines. Additionally, the General Santos Chamber of Commerce and Industries Inc. recognized MSU-Gensan as a "true entrepreneurial hero" for its pandemic-era efforts, highlighting the institution's role in supporting community resilience during unprecedented challenges.

Publications and Scholarship

Dr. Ali was a prolific scholar whose written work contributed significantly to the discourse on Islamic law and education in the Philippines. He authored two seminal books published by MSU-GSC: *The Evolution of Islamic Law in the Philippines: History, Texts and Analysis* (2009) and *The Muslim Educational Needs: An Exposition on the Fundamental Elements and Objectives of Islamic Education* (2012). Both works remain important references for understanding the development of Islamic legal systems and educational frameworks in the Philippine context.

Additionally, Dr. Ali published three articles in international academic journals addressing critical issues in Islamic Family Law, secularism in the application of Islamic Family Law, and legal impediments to implementing Islamic Family Law in the Philippines. These scholarly contributions reflected his expertise in navigating the complex intersections of religious law, secular legal systems, and Philippine jurisprudence.

Recognition and Awards

Dr. Ali's contributions to education and community service earned him significant recognition both nationally and internationally. In 2019, he was honored as one of UNESCO's Most Outstanding Educators in the Philippines, acknowledging his exceptional impact on educational development and his innovative approaches to university administration. He was also accorded the Mindanao Governance and Leadership Excellence Award, recognizing his exemplary leadership in advancing governance standards and institutional effectiveness in the Mindanao region.

Legacy

Chancellor Ali's academic accomplishments were prodigious, but his enduring legacy lies in his unwavering commitment to helping others and advancing the welfare of marginalized communities. His leadership vision encompassed not merely institutional excellence but a deeper social purpose: positioning MSU-GSC as a strong partner in improving the living conditions of Moro and Indigenous Peoples in Mindanao. He consistently fulfilled the university's mandate to provide quality education and administrative services to all stakeholders, demonstrating that academic leadership could be both intellectually rigorous and deeply humane.

The MSU-Gensan community remembers Chancellor Ali as a transformative leader whose work created lasting institutional structures—the College of Medicine, the Office of International Affairs, the ICT Office—that will continue serving students and communities for generations. His integration of Islamic scholarship with modern educational administration, his commitment to peace and development, and his visionary approach to university leadership established a standard of excellence that continues to inspire the institution he served with dedication and distinction.

See Also

- Mindanao State University System
- Islamic education in the Philippines
- Shari'ah law in the Philippines
- Bangsamoro higher education

External Links

- Mindanao State University - General Santos Official Website (https://www.msugensan.edu.ph/)
- Profile provided by Mohammad A Ali Mohjoe (https://www.facebook.com/joe.mohng)

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